

שרה. פרשת חיי שרה. לכאורה, to my mind, the first reference to sitting שבעה ever alluded to in the Torah is in שרה passed away, and it says (23:2) וַתָּמָת שָׂרָה, and the next פסוק says וַיָּקָם אַבְרָהָם מֵעַל פְּנֵי מֶתוּ. So what does it mean וַיָּקָם? It means he got up from שבעה.

אַל תִּירָא כִּי יִעָשֶׂר אִישׁ כִּי יִרְבֶּה כְּבוֹד (תהילים מ"ט:י"ז) has within it a pasuk - Don't be afraid if a person is wealthy, that the כבוד, the honor of his house, has become magnified; As they say in English, "You can't take it with you." In Yiddish they say, "There are no pockets in תכריכים." - לא ירד אַהָריו כְּבוֹדוֹ - His כבוד will not go down.

Rabbi Oelbaum, quoting the Satmar Rebbe זצ"ל, has a completely different take on this pasuk, which I have used in many, many שבעה calls, and it has been a נחמה for hundreds of people.

עשירות? ריכטיגע עשירות. After all, what is עשירות? - אַל תִּירָא כִּי יִעָשֶׂר אִישׁ - Don't be afraid if a person has עשירות. That is the true עשירות. עשירות בֵּיתוֹ. כִּי יִרְבֶּה כְּבוֹד בֵּיתוֹ - that his house has become magnified, that's a תורה'דיגע house, a שטיב full of Torah, full of people who are following in the footsteps of their עלטערן. עולטערן קאן הָפֵל. - כִּי לֹא בָמוֹתוֹ יָקָח הָפֵל. - the מיתה cannot take that away from you, ממש the exact opposite of how we טייטשט פשוט פשוט פשוט. The מיתה cannot possibly hurt that. - לֹא יֵרֵד אַהָריו כְּבוֹדוֹ - the כבוד will not go down, the כבוד will go up with the person.

It's a tremendous נחמה for a person to hear such a vort, that he knows that he is carrying on the tradition, the מסורה of the one who has passed away, and that מסורה will be ongoing as a שלשלת, as a link in the chain until בימינו אמן גואל צדק במהרה.

